

thinkaloud demo script

Google Flights: cheapest nonstop from Toronto Pearson to San Francisco on Oct 16. About 6 minutes. Tick the box as you do each thing. The lines are a starting point, so say them your way.

RUN ORDER

1	Intro	0:00
2	Start a recording	0:20
3	The flight search (recording)	0:45
4	Processing	2:05
5	Review the steps	2:15
6	Checklist and verdict	3:25
7	Privacy (optional)	4:10
8	Export	4:45
9	Managing recordings	5:20
10	Wrap	5:45

KEYS

While recording

F9 Stop recording

F8 Pause / resume

On the review page

← **→** Previous / next step (in Replay, plays it)

space Play this step, then pause

b **a** Before / after screenshot

n Next flag

e End state (checklist and verdict)

BEFORE YOU HIT RECORD

- ☐ **Open thinkaloud 0.2.1** (`thinkaloud-portable-0.2.1.exe` on your Desktop). Close any older copy first.
- ☐ **Do the task in Chrome, not Arc.** Arc hides the buttons on a web page from Windows, so every step says "Clicked at (x, y)". In Chrome it says what you clicked. Use a Guest window (profile icon → **Guest**) so no bookmarks, account or history show. Open Google Flights and maximize it.
- ☐ **Clean up the list:** tick your old test recordings, **Delete selected**, then **Empty Recently deleted** at the bottom.
- ☐ **Settings:** Speech recognition on **Accurate**, Gemini key saved. Do this before OBS starts, so the key is never on camera.
- ☐ **OBS:** Display Capture plus your mic. Don't give OBS the F8 or F9 hotkeys.
- ☐ **Do Not Disturb** on, Discord and other windows closed.
- ☐ **Practice once**, then check the review page: steps should name what you clicked, and each **Why** should be whole sentences.
- ☐ **For section 7 (optional):** record the fake sign-in first: open `C:\Users\admin\thinkaloud\docs\demo\signin.html` in Chrome, Task `Sign in to Harbor Portal`, Done when The page says `Signed in`, type `demo.reviewer@example.com` and a made-up password, click **Sign in**, **F9**.

1 Intro

0:00-0:20

- ☐ DO
Start on the **Recordings** page.

SAY
"Hi, I'm Zain, I study computer engineering at Waterloo. This is thinkaloud. You do a task on your computer and talk through what you're doing and why, and it turns that into training data for computer-use agents. The name is about as literal as it gets."

"I'll shop for a flight, review the recording, and export it. No actual booking, my bank account appreciates that."

2 Start a recording

0:20-0:45

- ☐ DO
Click **New recording**.

Task: Find the cheapest nonstop flight from Toronto Pearson (YYZ) to San Francisco (SFO) on October 16

Done when: The cheapest nonstop YYZ to SFO flight on October 16 is selected and its price is showing

SAY
"First I write down the task and what done looks like. Whoever reviews this later checks the final screen against it, and the speech-to-text uses it too, so it spells Pearson right."

- ☐ Talk until it says **We can hear you**. "It checks the mic first, and warns you if you picked a virtual one."

- ☐ Click **Start recording**. During the countdown, click into Chrome. (no line)

3 The flight search • THINKALOUD RECORDING

0:45-2:05

Talk to yourself, not the audience. **Say the reason, then do it**, and let each click land before the next sentence: the app splits what you say at those pauses and gives each sentence to the click that follows it.

☐ DO Trip type (says Round trip) → One way	SAY, THEN DO “One way. I just need to get there.”
☐ Click Where from? , type Pearson , pick Toronto Pearson International Airport	“From Pearson, since that’s the airport I can actually get to from Waterloo.”
☐ Click Where to? , type SFO , pick San Francisco International Airport	“SFO specifically. Oakland and San Jose are sometimes cheaper, but getting into the city from them isn’t.”
☐ Click Departure , pick 16 (October), click Done . Then Search . If it looks different: if the date picker shows two months, the 16th is in the October one. If the button says Explore , click that.	“Leaving October sixteenth. Searching.”
☐ Stops → Nonstop only , then close the menu. This is “the Nonstop step” used in section 5.	“Nonstop only. A connection might save fifty bucks, but it’d cost me half a day.”
☐ Click the Cheapest tab above the results.	“Switching to cheapest. The default ranks by other stuff too, like duration.”
☐ Look at the first result (Porter). Point at the carry-on bag icon. If it looks different: if the first result isn’t Porter or has no carry-on, say what’s actually on screen; a real reason beats a scripted one.	“Porter’s first, and it comes with a carry-on bag, so it’s still the cheapest once I count my bag. Perfect.”
☐ Click the Porter flight. Hold still 2 seconds: this screen is the final screenshot the checklist is checked against.	“That’s the one. Done.”
☐ Press F9	(no line)

4 Processing

2:05–2:15

☐ DO

Say this over the processing screen; cut the wait when you edit. The review page opens by itself.

SAY

“Processing runs on my laptop. It transcribes what I said, splits it into sentences, matches each one to the click it explains, pulls the screenshots and runs quality checks. Nothing gets uploaded.”

5 Review the steps

2:15–3:25

Show: every click has what was clicked, the screen before and after, and the reason, lined up in time.

☐ DO

Point at the timeline. Press  a few times and watch the shaded band move.

SAY

“Each tick on this timeline is one step. The shaded part is everything that belongs to the step I’ve picked, including what I said about it.”

☐ Go to **the Nonstop step** (the one that says **Clicked the Nonstop only...**, about two-thirds along). Open **Raw action and target**.

If it looks different: if it says “Clicked at (x, y)”, you recorded in Arc; skip this line.

“It records what I clicked by name, plus where it was on screen. The name comes from Windows accessibility data.”

☐ Point at the **Why** box and **carried from #...** above it.

“I said why right before I opened the Stops menu, so this click carries that reason, and it’s labelled as carried. It doesn’t pretend I said it here.”

☐ Press . Let it play and stop by itself.

“Space plays just this step, with what I said about it, and then stops.”

☐ Go to the last step (the Porter click). Click the green  **said before the action** chip under **Why**.

“These chips jump to exactly when I said each part. Green is before the click, orange is after, so a reason you gave ahead of time is kept apart from one you made up afterwards.”

☐ Press , then .

“The screen right before the click, and after it settled.”

☐ Fix a word in a **Why** box. It shows **edited by reviewer** and keeps the original underneath.

“Speech-to-text isn’t perfect, so a reviewer can fix the reasoning. The original stays on record.”

6 Checklist and verdict

3:25–4:10

Show: a person decides whether the task got done. The AI only suggests.

☐ **DO**
Press **e**.

SAY

"This is the final screen. Now, did the task actually get done?"

☐ Tick the consent box. **Draft checklist from "done when"**, then **Accept** the drafts.

"AI drafts a checklist from my done-when. Nothing is sent until I tick this, and nothing counts until I accept it."

☐ **Check final screen against checklist.**

"Then it checks the final screenshot against each item."

☐ The "cheapest" item will probably say **can't be determined**. Click back to the **Cheapest** tab step, then mark it **Met** yourself.

"It can't tell this was the cheapest, which is fair, the other flights aren't on this screen. I sorted by cheapest right here, so I'll mark it met myself."

☐ Click **Task done**.

"Task done. Only recordings a person marked done should be used as examples of doing it right, otherwise you're training an agent on a failed attempt."

7 Privacy OPTIONAL

4:10–4:45

☐ **DO**
← **recordings**, open the Harbor Portal sign-in. Click the password step.

SAY

"I recorded a sign-in earlier on a fake local page. The password step only says how many characters went into a password field. The keystrokes were never saved."

☐ Click the email step: [REDACTED] and a red **possible email** flag.

"The email is redacted in the data, but it's still in the screenshots, so export is blocked until a person looks."

☐ **Export...** → **Export** (it's skipped) → **I checked the privacy flags: export anyway.**

"It's a fake address, so I'll let it through. F8 pauses everything for anything private mid-task."

8 Export

4:45–5:20

☐ **DO**
Flight recording → **Export...**, both formats ticked, **Export**.

SAY

"Export writes two formats: a plain dataset any lab can load, and Claude's computer-use format, where every step is a tool call with the screenshot as its result."

☐ Point at **Bundle validation: passed**.

"It checks the bundle before calling it done: checksums, schema, screenshot timing and coordinates."

☐ Open
Documents\thinkaloud\exports\ → newest → recordings\
<id>\trajectory.json; scroll to the Nonstop step. Then claude\
<id>.json.

"Here's the Nonstop click: what got clicked, the reason, when I said it, and the before and after screenshots. And the same step as a Claude tool call."

9 Managing recordings

5:20–5:45

☐ **DO**
← **recordings**. Point at the numbers along the top and the **Review** column.

SAY

"With a bunch of contributors you'd have a pile of these. This page shows how much of each one is narrated, what's still flagged, and what the reviewer decided."

☐ Hover a row: **Edit · Show in folder · Delete**. Select a few, point at **Process selected** and **Workers**.

"Recordings can be renamed or deleted, and deleted ones sit in Recently deleted until you empty it. You can process a backlog a few at a time and export a whole selection as one bundle."

SAY

“Computer-use agents need the reasoning behind each click and a person’s word that the task actually got done, without anyone’s email ending up in the data. That’s what thinkaloud does. It’s Windows only for now, which is a polite way of saying I haven’t figured out Mac yet. Thanks for watching.”

WHEN YOU EDIT

- Cut the processing wait and dead air.
- Zoom in on the side panel and timeline in section 5; the text is small at 1080p.
- Over 6 minutes? Drop section 7, then shorten section 9.